

BEAVER COUNTY COMMISSIONERS

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BEAVER COUNTY & COMMUNITY PARTNERS SECURE \$600,000 EPA GRANT FOR BROWNFIELDS REVITALIZATION

Board of Commissioners

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BEAVER COUNTY COMMISSIONERS

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BEAVER, PA – Beaver County, Pennsylvania secured a \$600,000 “Brownfields Assessment” grant from the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), which will enable the County and its community partners to conduct environmental investigations on contaminated properties, and plan productive reuse and revitalization of these brownfields. Beaver County partnered with the Borough of Monaca, the Borough of Midland, the City of Aliquippa, and Moon Township in Allegheny County to form the “Ohio River Brownfields Coalition” and to pursue this funding. The EPA fact sheet on the Beaver County funding can be seen at http://cfpub.epa.gov/bf_factsheets/gfs/index.cfm?xpg_id=8549&display_type=HTML.

The Beaver and Allegheny County region along the Ohio River have been through major struggles with the decline of the steel industry, the loss of tens of thousands of jobs, and major environmental contamination challenges. But Beaver County and its partners are poised to continue their progress to transform these brownfields into a vibrant corridor of new advanced manufacturing, mixed-use sustainable development, a key segment of the Ohio River Trail, and new community park and recreational areas. Beaver County Commissioner Dennis Nichols, who joined with his fellow Commissioners Tony Amadio and Joe Spanik to spearhead the effort, says “Our Ohio River coalition is ready to move forward on revitalization and innovation, and we commend U.S. EPA for its continued partnership with Beaver County and its communities.” Commissioner Nichols notes that this EPA brownfields grant funding builds on other partnerships with the federal government including an EPA Brownfields Area-Wide Planning Grant (www.OhioRiverBrownfields.com) and a Manufacturing Community Revitalization Roundtable in December 2013 that convened top federal, state, local, non-profit and private sector leaders. The Beaver County Commissioners were pleased to work with local leaders on these efforts, including among many others the elected officials and management in the coalition communities, including Monaca Borough Manager Mario Leone Jr., Midland Borough Manager Diane Kemp, Aliquippa City Administrator Samuel Gill, and Moon Township Manager Jean Creese and her team.

The EPA grant can be used to identify strategies for productive reuse and redevelopment of brownfield sites. It will also be used to conduct environmental assessments and investigations at targeted public and private brownfield properties, in order to prepare those sites for cleanup and redevelopment. Beaver County will work through its Department of Planning & Economic Development and its Director Frank Mancini, Jr. to join with leaders in Monaca, Midland, Aliquippa and Moon to identify these sites and put the EPA resources to work there. The community has already identified 30 potential brownfields with hazardous waste and/or petroleum contamination where this funding could be put to use. Owners or potential developers of brownfields properties in Beaver County or Moon Township who may be interested in being considered for this funding are encouraged to contact the Beaver County Department of Planning, see <http://www.beavercountypa.gov/planning-commission-directory-planning-staff>. Beaver County and its community partners will provide the public and interested organizations with more information as the grant funding is put in place later in 2014.

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